

# Jiayi Zhang

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## EDUCATION

|                                                                                                                                            |                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>The University of Hong Kong</b><br><i>PhD</i> , advised by Dr. Chenxiong Qian on game security                                          | May 2024 – Present<br>Hong Kong  |
| <b>The University of Hong Kong</b><br><i>MSc</i> in Computer Science (Distinction)                                                         | Sep 2022 – Dec 2023<br>Hong Kong |
| <b>Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications</b><br><i>BMgt</i> in E-Commerce Engineering with Law (GPA: 85.02/100.00 (3.42/4.0)) | Sep 2018 – Jul 2022<br>Beijing   |
| <b>Queen Mary University of London</b><br><i>BSc(Eng)(Hons.)</i> in E-Commerce Engineering with Law (First Class Honours)                  | Sep 2018 – Jul 2022<br>London    |

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

|                                                                                                                                  |                                  |
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| <b>The University of Hong Kong</b><br>Research Assistant on game security                                                        | Jan 2023 – Apr 2024<br>Hong Kong |
| <b>University of Michigan</b><br>Remote project on modern compiler construction and optimization, instructor: Prof. Lingjia Tang | Jul 2021 – Sep 2021<br>Beijing   |

## PUBLICATIONS

★ Selected
C Conference
J Journal
TOP Top-tier Venue

- Zhang, J.**, Sun, C. and Qian, C. (2026). XGuardian: Towards Explainable and Generalized AI Anti-Cheat on FPS Games. *In 35rd USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Security 26)*. ★ C TOP
- Zhang, J.**, Sun, C., Gu, Y., Zhang, Q., Lin, J., Du, X. and Qian, C. (2026). Identify as a Human Does: A Pathfinder of Next-Generation Anti-Cheat Framework for First-Person Shooter Games. *IEEE Transactions on Information Forensics and Security*, 21, pp.240–255. doi:https://doi.org/10.1109/tifs.2025.3635024. ★ J TOP
- Sun, C., Ye, K., Su, L., **Zhang, J.** and Qian, C. (2024). Invisibility Cloak: Proactive Defense Against Visual Game Cheating. *In 33rd USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Security 24)*. C TOP
- Sun, C., **Zhang, J.**, Ye, K., and Qian, C. (Under review). (Anonymous title, visual cheat prevention method on FPS games). In submission to an *anonymous conference*. C
- Sun, C., **Zhang, J.**, and Qian, C. (Under review). (Anonymous title, cheat detection method on Battle Royal games). In submission to an *anonymous journal*. J
- Zhang, J.** (2021). Performance Comparative Analysis on Garbage First Garbage Collector and Z Garbage Collector. *2021 IEEE 3rd International Conference on Frontiers Technology of Information and Computer (ICFTIC)*. doi:https://doi.org/10.1109/icftic54370.2021.9647167. C

## ONGOING PROJECTS

- project-reckoning**: an aim-assist cheat detection method addressing (obfuscated) industrial concerns and academia drawbacks
- project-nova**: a survey on an emerging hardware-based cheat against existing anti-cheat
- project-jinx**: a SoK on cheat, anti-cheat, their existing research gap, and their possible developments

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Game security and anti-cheat
- Emerging cheats or attacks on games
- Other practical or emerging topics on games

## AWARDS

- 2024–2028, HKU PGS
- 2020–2021, BUPT UG Scholarship
- 2021, Best oral speaker of 3rd IEEE ICFTIC

## SERVICES

- ACSAC 2023**,  
Artifact Evaluation reviewer

## TEACHING

- TA, COMP3278A – Introduction to DBMS [25/26, 26/27]
- TA, COMP7906A – Introduction to Cyber Security [24/25]

## SELECTED TALKS

- 15 min**, XGuardian @ Baltimore, 35th USENIX Security
- 15 min**, Invisibility Cloak @ Philadelphia, 33rd USENIX Security